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CURRICULUM

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1.1 INTRODUCTION

This Chapter provides insights and deep understanding of every specific aspect that makes up a curriculum. Curriculum is both a structured document and a dynamic process that evolves with changing educational needs and societal expectations. The essential elements of curriculum include objectives, content or subject matter, teaching-learning experiences, and assessment strategies. The need for curriculum arises from the need to provide relevant education by providing systematic, planned, age-appropriate and culturally responsive learning experiences that prepare learners for life and work in a changing world. It prepares them effectively for personal growth, social participation and professional life in a dynamic world. A major focus of the chapter is curriculum frameworks, which provide the philosophical and structural basis

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for curriculum design. It highlights major national frameworks in India such as the National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Stage (NCF-FS 2022) and the National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE 2023). These frameworks are in line with the vision of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, which aims to ensure inclusive, equitable and competency-based education at all stages. The chapter also discusses curriculum goals, competencies and learning outcomes as interrelated components. Curriculum goals define broad educational aspirations, competencies are the abilities and skills that learners are expected to develop, and learning outcomes specify measurable achievements at the end of the learning process. All these components help plan, implement and evaluate effective teaching-learning processes.

**1.2 LEARNING OUTCOMES**

After completion of this chapter, the learner

- describes the concepts of curriculum and curriculum framework and its essential elements;
- explains curriculum in the context of the National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Stage (NCF-FS, 2022) and School Education (NCF-SE, 2023);
- comprehends how curriculum, curriculum goals, competencies and learning outcomes are interrelated;
- implements competency-based classroom strategies aligned with NCF-FS2022 and NCF-SE 2023.

1.3 CONCEPT OF CURRICULUM

Curriculum is a pre-structured plan for learning. Curriculum is the guiding path along which learners are anticipated and targeted to grasp knowledge, skills and learning experiences. Without it, the education system at the school level becomes aimless and deviates from its goal. Therefore, a well-structured curriculum ensures that learning is purposeful, organised and aligned with educational goals.

The word curriculum is derived from a Latin word which translates in English to “to run,” “a way of running,” or “a course of running”—that is, a curriculum. Curriculum is a means to achieve the goals of education. It includes all types of

experiences gained from factors such as activities, actions and environmental influences that help learners to attain various desired goals during their educational life.

Curriculum is not limited to narrow subject content like syllabus. 'Curriculum' refers not only to textbooks and other teaching-learning materials (TLM) and the subject content or syllabus for their teaching, but also includes aspects such as school environment and culture.

Table 1.1 : Difference between Curriculum and Syllabus

S.No	Curriculum	Syllabus
1	A comprehensive and long-term plan covering educational goals, content, methods and assessment for an entire course or stage of education.	Short term and narrow planning covering specific topics, subtopics and learning outcomes, subject-wise.
2	Framed by National Agencies or authorities (e.g., NCERT, CBSE, State Boards).	Framed by teachers or institutions based on the curriculum.
3	Focuses on holistic development of learners.	Focuses on subject-specific content mastery.
4	The curriculum is revised and developed based on the needs of the students.	Changes and modifications are made based on the curriculum. It is less flexible, more fixed and standardised.

1.3.1 Definitions of Curriculum

The Mudaliar Commission (Secondary Education Commission, 1952–53) defined curriculum not just as the academic subjects traditionally taught in schools but as “the totality of experiences which a student gains through the various activities of the school – the classroom, the library, the laboratory, the workshop, the playground and the many informal contacts between teachers and learners.”

Curriculum is generally regarded as all the experiences which learners receive under the auspices of the school (Doll, 1996).

Hilda Taba (1962) defined curriculum as a plan of action or a written document containing strategies to be adopted to achieve desired goals or objectives.



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Curriculum is the set of experiences that all learners receive individually from programs of education aimed at achieving broad goals and related specific objectives, planned within the framework of theory and research or past and current professional practice (Hass, 1987).

The curriculum includes all of the school experiences of learners that help to improve skills, experiences and strategies to think critically and creatively, solve problems, work together with others, communicate well, read and write more effectively, coordinate analytically and do research to solve problems. Brown (2006).

According to Tanner and Tanner (2007), Curriculum is the restructuring of knowledge and experiences, developed systematically in the school environment, so that the learner can increase his mastery of knowledge and experience.

There are many elements involved in creating a curriculum, these include goals and objectives, syllabus, subjects, content and topic to be taught and learned, pedagogical practices and assessment, teaching-learning materials, school and classroom practices, the learning environment and culture of the institution, and more. It also includes elements that directly impact the curriculum and its practice that may be an essential part of the curriculum even if they are not within the curriculum. These include teachers and their qualifications, involvement of parents and communities, access issues to institutions, available resources, administrative and support frameworks, and more. (NCF-SE 2023)

1.2.3 Essential Elements of Curriculum

- 1. Learning Goals & Objectives:** The curriculum clearly defines the learning goals for the learner, making it clear what the learner should know after the learning process? What should he/she understand? And what tasks should he/she be able to perform to what level? These learning outcomes determine the direction of both teaching and assessment. These objectives are observable and measurable.

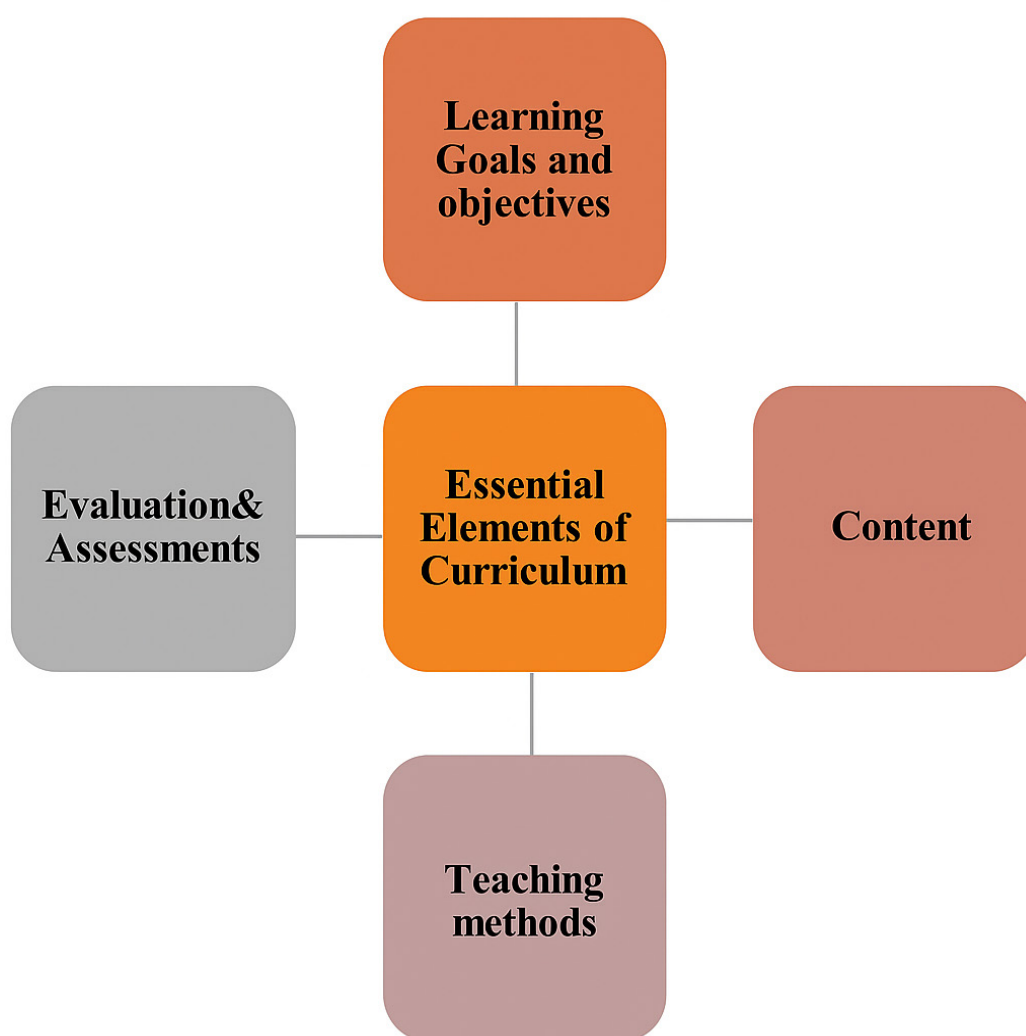


Fig 1.1: Essential Elements of Curriculum

2. **Content:** The content included in the curriculum refers to the subject matter, topics, concepts and information that will be taught to learners in the classroom. The curriculum aligns the selection of content, its importance, relevance, age-appropriateness with the learning objectives.

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Indian Knowledge System: Our country is also home to deep knowledge and extensive practice in a variety of disciplines and fields, from language to Mathematics, Philosophy to Art grammar to astronomy, Ecology to Medicine, Architecture to Agriculture, Ethics to governance crafts to technologies. Psychology to Politics, literature to Music and Economics to Education. It is therefore important that all curriculum and pedagogy from the Foundational Stage onwards, is designed to be strongly rooted in the Indian and local context and ethos in terms of culture, traditions, heritage, customs, language, philosophy, geography, ancient and contemporary knowledge, societal and scientific needs, indigenous and traditional ways to learning etc. - (NCF SE 2023, pg. 143)

Interdisciplinary Areas: The interdisciplinary area in the curriculum, aims to break subject boundaries and promote holistic understanding. It encourages students to combine knowledge across subjects to solve real-life problems. In the foundational and preparatory stages, interdisciplinarity is embedded through domains such as the world around us. In the middle stage, curriculum goals integrate concepts from multiple disciplines. In the secondary stage, a separate interdisciplinary area is introduced with topics such as environmental education, the individual in society, and sustainability. This approach promotes critical thinking, collaboration, and values essential for 21st-century learners. (NCF SE 2023, pg. 386)

3. **Teaching Pedagogy & Methods:** Pedagogy is the teaching methodology and practices used by teachers to help learners learn in classrooms. It supports how learners grow and learn, and has a clear focus on curriculum goals, competencies, and learning outcomes for students. It includes all the strategies, approaches, activities and resources that teachers use to facilitate learners' learning and engagement with the content.

NEP 2020 states: A good educational institution is one in which every student feels welcomed and cared for, where a safe and stimulating learning environment exists, where a wide range of learning experiences are offered, and where good physical infrastructure and appropriate resources conducive to learning are available to all students. (NEP 2020, Principles, NCF SE p99)

4. **Evaluation & Assessment:** Curriculum sets the direction and scope of evaluation. Evaluation includes the methods and tools used to measure and assess learners' learning and progress toward achieving the set objectives. It is a comprehensive process of determining the effectiveness and value

of the curriculum. It involves collecting data on student learning outcomes, teacher experiences, and other relevant factors for revision and improvement.

1.3.3 Factors Affecting Curriculum

Curriculum is a dynamic framework that reflects the educational goals of society. It is shaped by many factors that influence it and ensure that it remains relevant, inclusive, and visionary. Philosophical, psychological, sociological, political, economic, technological, and environmental factors influence curriculum design, making it responsive to the needs of learners and the changing demands of the world.



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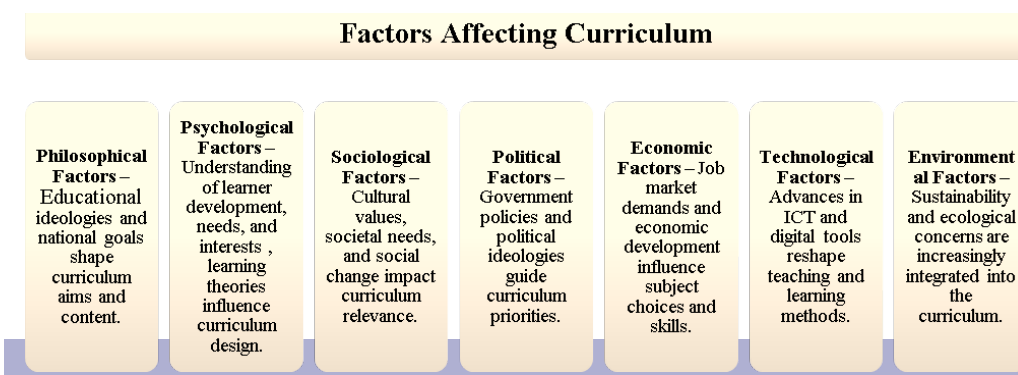


Fig. 1.2: Factors Affecting Curriculum

1.4 NEED OF CURRICULUM

1. **Addresses the Changing Needs of Society:** The curriculum addresses the changes taking place in society, science, technology and globalisation and with these changes, helps in updating the curriculum to meet modern challenges such as digital literacy, artificial intelligence, environmental awareness and life skills to equip learners with relevant knowledge and skills.
2. **Provides Direction and Clarity:** The curriculum explains learning outcomes, teaching pedagogy, content, learning and assessment methods with clarity, helping teachers to plan and deliver effective instruction (Tyler, 1949). It ensures coherence across grades and different subjects, thereby enabling systematic progress in learning.

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3. **Promotes Holistic Development:** A well-designed curriculum focuses on the holistic development of learners i.e. cognitive, emotional, physical, social, cultural and moral development (NCF, 2005). It integrates academic knowledge with life skills, values and attitudes to prepare learners for real-world challenges.
4. **Links Education to National Goals:** The curriculum reflects a nation's vision for socio-cultural and economic priorities through education. In India, the National Education Policy-2020 emphasises the need for a curriculum that promotes 21st century values and knowledge by promoting critical thinking, creativity, multilingualism, and ethical reasoning in alignment with constitutional values.
5. **Ensures Equity and Inclusiveness:** A standardised curriculum helps bridge inequalities by providing access to equal quality education and learning opportunities to all learners regardless of their background (rich, poor, rural, urban, boy, girl), etc.
6. **Supports Competency-Based Education (CBE):** The curriculum emphasises experiential learning, learning by doing, competency-based learning, and learning outcomes rather than memorizing content. This shift ensures that learners acquire applicable skills and knowledge that are meaningful and relevant (NCF-SE, 2023).
7. **Facilitates Assessment and Evaluation:** The curriculum provides the basis for developing clear assessments that align with learning goals, helping teachers not only measure their own progress and identify areas for improvement but also measure learners' progress and identify areas for improvement (Bloom, 1956).

**CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 1.1**

Write your answer in 50 words.

1. Define syllabus in your own words ?
2. How do sociological factors influence curriculum?
3. How can you implement Indian Knowledge Systems (IKS) at the Foundational Stage of education?

1.5 NATIONAL CURRICULUM FRAMEWORKS IN INDIA

Curriculum framework is a written national-level educational document that is more precise, purposeful, pre-planned, systematic and covering extensive areas than the syllabus - National Curriculum Framework is the most essential tool for ensuring uniformity and consistency in the 'curriculum system' of the entire country. It provides the framework and guidelines for developing specific curriculum.

The school curriculum of a country, like its constitution, reflects the ethos and core concerns of that country. Curriculum framework also outlines the philosophical, scientific, social and psychological basis, theories of learning and overall goals of education within a particular context (e.g., a nation, a state or an educational institution). The framework serves as a guide for curriculum developers, ensuring consistency, quality and coherence across different subjects and grade levels.

Curriculum framework is a plan that formulates educational objectives with respect to both the individual and society. At the individual level it nurtures ethical, creative and lifelong learners and at the societal level it builds a just, equitable, sustainable and culturally rooted society that contributes to India's development and global leadership. The curriculum framework provides guidelines for putting the plan of education into practice at different stages of learning.

1.5.1 The National Curriculum Framework for School Education, India

In India, the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) is an apex body involved in the development of the school education system which prepares the curriculum framework for school level education. Similarly, the National Council of Teacher Education (NCTE) develops the curriculum framework for B.Ed. and M.Ed. programmes keeping in view the teaching skills and training of prospective teachers. NCERT has developed five major national curriculum frameworks so far (by the year 2025) in 1975, 1988, 2000, 2005 and 2023. The first curriculum "Framework for a Ten-Year School Curriculum (1975)" emphasised on national integration, moral education and linking education to constitutional values. The second curriculum "National Curriculum for Primary and Secondary Education (1988)" was prepared after the National Policy on Education (1986). This NCF focused on child-centred education, minimum learning levels (MLL) and vocational training.

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NCF 2000 added to the previous ones by giving more emphasis on life skills, use of technology and value education. NCF 2005 marked a paradigm shift towards reducing rote learning by promoting constructive learning through critical and creative thinking and “learning without burden”. The latest NCF 2023 based on the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 is divided into four parts which are NCF-FS 2022 and NCF SE 2023 which introduces a stage-wise framework (foundational, preparatory, middle and secondary) while promoting competency-based, experiential and multidisciplinary learning rooted in Indian knowledge systems. While National Curriculum Framework for Teacher Education (NCF TE) and National Curriculum Framework for Adult Education (NCF AE) are still being prepared.

Table 1.2 Curriculum vs. National curriculum framework (NCF)

Aspect	Curriculum	National Curriculum Framework (NCF)
Meaning	A set of topics and activities that learners learn through academic programs and other interactive curricular activities to gain a holistic experience.	A document that provides guidelines for designing curriculum, pedagogy and assessment to bring about educational uniformity at the national level.
Nature	Instructional and specific to different grades, subjects, and stages of education.	A comprehensive guidelines for the development of different courses.
Implementation	Used directly by schools and teachers for classroom teaching.	Serves as a reference document for boards (CBSE, ICSE, state boards) to design their own curricula.
Purpose	Specifies what learners should learn at different educational levels.	Offers philosophical, scientific, social, psychological and pedagogical guidance to align education with national goals and policies.



Flexibility	Generally fixed and revised periodically.	Dynamic and adaptable; revised periodically based on changing educational needs and policies.
Prepared & Developed By	Educational boards, universities, and institutions based on NCF guidelines.	Developed by NCERT under the guidance of the Ministry of Education.
Examples	CBSE, ICSE, and state board syllabi.	NCF 1975, NCF 1988, NCF 2000, NCF 2005, NCF 2023.
Assessment Methods	Specifies the examination pattern, grading system, and evaluation criteria.	Recommends reforms such as competency-based learning and continuous comprehensive evaluation (CCE).

1.5.2 National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Stage 2022 (NCF-FS 2022)

As per para 4.1 of the New Education Policy 2020, the '*pedagogical structure and curriculum framework of school education will follow a 5+3+3+4 design, comprising the Foundational Stage (in two parts, i.e. 3 years of Anganwadi/pre-school + 2 years of primary school in Classes 1-2; both together covering ages 3-8 years), Preparatory Stage (Classes 3-5, covering ages 8-11 years), Middle Stage (Classes 6-8, covering ages 11-14 years) and Secondary Stage (Classes 9-10 and 11-12, covering ages 14-18 years)*' (pg. 11)

The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 is a major transformational and revolutionary step towards preparing India to meet the challenging demands of the 21st century society. Embracing the objectives, principles and vision of NEP 2020, a detailed National Curriculum Framework in the form of NCF-FS 2022 was prepared by the NCERT at the Foundational Stage (ages 3-8) as an empowering tool to realise the challenging transformation. It is India's first integrated curriculum framework specifically designed for children between the ages of 3 to 8 years. According to NEP 2020, it adopts a holistic and integrated approach to early childhood care and education, targeting children in the foundational stage (3 to 8 years of age). It also shows a clear path towards the goal of achieving basic literacy and numeracy as articulated in NEP 2020, including age-appropriate strategies, use of 'play' at the core of curriculum organisation, pedagogy,

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time and content organisation, and conceptual, operational and transactional approaches to the holistic experience of the child.

1.5.3 National Curriculum Framework for School Education 2023 (NCF-SE 2023)

The National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE-23) aims to realise its vision of fostering the unique capabilities of each student by guiding the necessary reforms in the school curriculum in line with the national needs and future aspirations as described in the National Education Policy 2020. This curriculum framework is an integrated curriculum framework for children aged 3-18 years in the school education system. It is a direct outcome of the 5+3+3+4 'curriculum and pedagogy' framework that NEP 2020 introduced for school education. NCF-SE-23 is an integrated framework, where each part has an impact on the other part.

The National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE-2023) is systematically designed in five parts. Part A outlines the broad objectives of school education, the steps required to achieve these objectives, values, dispositions as well as the principles of content, teaching and assessment in four stages. Part B of the curriculum framework addresses cross-cutting themes such as roots in India, environmental awareness, inclusive education, value education, guidance and counselling, and educational technology. While Part C covers subject-wise (language, mathematics, social sciences, science, arts, physical education etc) teaching standards, content, pedagogy and assessment covering the foundational and secondary stages. Part D of the curriculum focuses on school culture and values, while the final Part E details the necessary ecosystem - teacher capacity, infrastructure and community participation like role of Schol Management Committees.

Table 1.3 Salient Features of NCF-SE 2023 & NCF-FS 2022

Aspect	NCF for School Education (NCF-SE) 2023	NCF for Foundational Stage (NCF-FS) 2022
Grades	The entire school education from Grades 3 to 12	Only Foundational Stage (3 years of preschool + Grades 1 and 2)



Stage-wise Coverage	Preparatory, Middle, and Secondary stages (Grades 3–12)	Covers only Foundational Stage (ages 3–8)
Target Age Group	Approx. 8 to 18 years	3 to 8 years
Focus Areas	Emphasis on learning outcomes, skills, and career guidance, subject-specific learning, competency-based education, interdisciplinary approach, board exams reform	Emphasis on developmental goals and development of core competencies, holistic development, play-based learning, early literacy and numeracy
Pedagogical Approach	Emphasis on experiential learning, Problem solving, discussion-based, and interdisciplinary learning	Play-based, activity-based, story-based learning
Assessment Approach	Formative, diagnostic, and summative assessments aligned with competencies	Observational and play-based continuous assessment (no formal testing)
Learning Outcomes	Clearly and systematically defined the competencies and learning outcomes for per subject and grade	Focus on developmental goals, learning outcomes related to domains like cognitive, language, motor, social-emotional
Teacher Role	Facilitator of deeper understanding, reasoning, and applied knowledge	Nurturer and observer of developmental progress, emotional security, curiosity
Features	Indian Knowledge System; Curriculum load reduction; Flexibility in subject choices; Multilingualism Integration of vocational and academic subjects	Emphasis on ECCE principles; Indian Knowledge System Child-centred curriculum Use of local context and culture in learning materials

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Language	Promotion of multilingualism, use of home language/regional language in early years	Strongly promotes and advocate mother tongue/home language as the medium of learning and instruction
Alignment with NEP 2020	Fully aligned; operationalises key reforms like 5+3+3+4 framework, holistic report cards, competency-based education	First framework under NEP 2020; establishes foundation for later stages

1.6 CURRICULAR GOALS, COMPETENCIES AND LEARNING OUTCOMES

The National Curriculum Frameworks (NCF-SE 2023 and NCF-FS 2022) outline a structured progression of learning structure and sequence through aims, goals, competencies and learning outcomes aligned with NEP 2020. The curriculum defines clear goals, essential competencies and measurable learning outcomes to ensure meaningful, inclusive education at all stages of schooling, promote foundational skills, critical thinking, values and lifelong learning. These interlinked levels guide curriculum design, teaching and assessment to ensure holistic development of learners.

1.6.1 Curricular Goals

Curricular goals are highly specific and precise statements that act as a motivator in the planning, designing and implementation of the curriculum, which will enable the successful achievement of curricular goals as the product of the strategies employed. They are accomplished through educational aims and can be adapted for a stage of education (e.g., Foundation Stage) as well as a part of the curriculum (e.g., Language and Mathematics etc.). All curricular goals in NCF-FS 2022 and NCF-SE 2023 are directed and provide step-by-step curricular goals for all stages. One such curricular goal in the Foundation Stage can be illustrated as, “Acquire or develop effective communication skills used in day-to-day interactions in two languages”.

1.6.2 Competencies

Competencies indicate learning progress or learning gains that are observable



and measurable through a systematic process. These competencies are directly linked to curricular goals and are expected to be acquired by the completion of each stage. The competencies are mentioned in the NCF-FS-2022 and NCF-SE-2023. “Develop effective communication skills for day-to-day interactions in two languages” is one such curricular goal for the Foundation Stage. Some examples of competencies to be achieved for this curricular goal are – ‘Can speak and converse fluently and meaningfully’ and ‘Understands verbal instructions for complex tasks and gives clear verbal instructions to others for the same.’

Competency-based curriculum emphasises a learner-centred approach. Competencies such as self-efficacy, citizenship, digital literacy, communication and collaboration, learning to learn, imagination and creativity, decision-making skills and finding solutions through learning by doing can be developed in learners through a competency-based curriculum. Competency-based education focuses on what learners learn and how they learn it. Holistic and summative assessments after completing each stage of schooling (foundational, preparatory, middle and secondary) should be centred around these competencies.

1.6.3 Learning Outcomes

There should be interim markers/indicators of learning achievements, which will ensure that teachers are able to monitor and track learning progress and respond to learners’ needs on a regular and consistent basis. Learning outcomes (LOs) are detailed learning milestones that must be achieved within a specified time period. These intermediate markers/indicators are defined and addressed as learning outcomes.

Learning outcomes can be defined based on socio-cultural contexts, available materials and resources, and specific classroom competencies. Hence, learning outcomes are better trackers/ indicators/ bench markers of learning progress and follow a sequence that results in the achievement of a competency. Learning outcomes provide teachers to autonomy to plan and design their teaching content, learning strategies, methodology, and assessment with the aim of achieving specific competencies. Competencies should be linked to learning outcomes which teachers are free to define according to the contexts of their classes.



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1.7 INTERRELATIONSHIP OF CURRICULAR GOALS, COMPETENCIES, AND LEARNING OUTCOMES

The NCF-SE & FS derives the aims and goals of education in line with the recommendations of the NEP 2020. Curricular goals are framed from Curricular aims. These curricular goals then lead to competencies, and those competencies lead to learning outcomes.

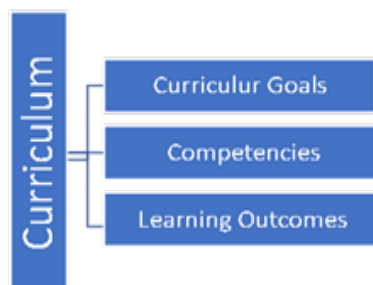


Fig 1.3: Components of Curriculum

Figures 1.3 and 1.4 show the logical progression of broad concepts and aim of education into specific learning outcomes. Through transparent links between curricular goals, competencies and learning outcomes, all stakeholders are able to monitor and evaluate the learning ecosystem across the educational learning achievements of all learners.



Fig 1.4: Example of ‘Components of Curriculum’



Domain: Language and Literacy Development at Foundational Stage

Curricular Goal: Developing effective communication skills in learners in two languages in daily life communication situations is a major goal (CG-9) for the foundation level curriculum.

Competencies: Communicate fluently, have meaningful conversations and understand verbal instructions for complex tasks and give clear verbal instructions to others. (CG 9.3)

Learning Outcome: ‘Can communicate fluently and carry-on meaningful conversations.’

For example, the table (2.1A, NCF-FS 2022, p 45) can be used as an illustration of the learning outcomes achieved for competency in the Foundation Stage:

Table 1.4: Level wise Competencies for Age 3-8 Years Learners

	Level A	Level B	Level C	Level D	Level E
Competency					
Converses Fluently and can hold a meaningful conversation					
Age 3-8 Years					
1	Listens attentively and speaks in short conversations with familiar people around	Initiates conversations in daily life with peers and teachers in a variety of school settings	Engages in conversations based on events, experiences or their needs and pose questions	Engages in conversations, waits for their turn to speak, and gives others a chance to express their views	Maintains the thread of the conversation smoothly over several replies
2	Expresses their needs and feelings through short meaningful sentences	Narrates daily experiences in simple and small sentences, asks easy and simple questions (what/when/how/whom, etc.)	Narrates daily experiences in elaborate descriptions and asks 'why' questions too	Engages with non-fictional content read aloud or discussed in class is able to link knowledge from their own experiences and talks about it.	Engages in discussion/conversation on topics like racism and answers questions.

NCFFS 2022, p 45, Table 2.1 A

**Notes****EXAMPLE-2: PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT****Table 1.5: Curricular Goals & Competencies**

Domains	Curricular Goal	Competencies
Physical Development	CG-1 Children develop habits that keep them healthy and safe	C-1.1 Shows a liking for and understanding of nutritious food and does not waste food
		C-1.3 Practices basic self-care and hygiene
		C-1.3 Keeps school/classroom hygienic and organised
		C-1.4 Practices safe use of material and simple tools
		C-1.5 Shows awareness of safety in movements (walking, running, cycling) and acts appropriately
		C-1.6 Understands unsafe situations and ask for help
	CG-2 Children develop sharpness in sensorial perceptions	C-2.1 Differentiates between shapes, colours and their shades
		C-2.2 Develops visual memory for symbols and representations
		C-2.3 Differentiates sounds and sound patterns by their pitch volume and tempo
		C-2.4 Differentiates multiple smells and tastes
		C-2.5 Develops discrimination in the sense of touch
		C-2.6 Being integrating sensorial perceptions to get a holistic awareness of their experiences
	CG-3 Children develop a fit and flexible body	C-3.1 Shows coordination between sensorial perceptions and body movements in various activities
		C-3.2 Shows balance, coordination and flexibility in various physical activities
		C-3.3 Shows precision and control in working with their hands and fingers
		C-3.4 Shows strength and endurance in carrying walking and running

NCFFS 2022, 2.4, P53

The competencies achieved from the curricular goals in the physical development domain are described by learning outcomes. This can be understood by the sample given on (NCF-FS, p 64) of how learning outcomes can be formulated at the foundational stage.

Curricular Goal (CG-2): Children develop sharpness in sensorial perceptions

Competency (C-2.1): Differentiates between shapes, colours, and their shades



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Table 1.6: Level wise Learning Outcomes for Age 3-8 Years Learners

Level A	Level B	Level C	level D	Level E	
Learning Outcomes					
C-2.1: Differentiates between shapes, colours, and their shades					
Age 3-8 Years					
1	Differentiates and names the primary colours (red, blue, yellow) and other common colours in their environment (black, white, brown)	Differentiates shades within primary colours and secondary colours (e.g., light blue, dark blue, light green, dark green)	Attempts to predict resulting colour when two colours are mixed (e.g., blue and yellow makes green, or red and white makes pink)	Predicts resulting colour when two colours are mixed	Experiments and use colours in art forms and drawings, decorating, display
2	Groups objects based on their colour (e.g., all red things together)	Groups objects based on dimension - length, breadth, height (e.g., all long things together)	Groups objects based on combinations of visual characteristics of colours and shapes (e.g., all red triangles together, all large green leaves together)	Makes patterns, solves puzzles, plays games using identification and grouping of various shapes, colours and shades	

Source: NCFFS2022, p 58

The figure (1.4) and table (1.4, 1.5 & 1.6) clearly illustrate how the competencies and learning outcomes develop progressively from basic communication to advanced reasoning and argumentation. How the transition from simple conversation to critical evaluation of arguments, emotional self-awareness and logical thinking is encouraged and developed.

The structured design of aims, goals, competencies and outcomes helps to trace how language education builds up systematically over time. This ensures that learners also learn to use their reasoning, democratic participation and problem-solving skills appropriately to develop linguistic competencies and skills. Thus, the table shows how the learning outcomes promote the core competencies from the foundational stage to the long-term secondary stage.

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**CHECK YOUR PROGRESS 1.2**

1. Write True or False for the following statements:
 - a) The curriculum refers only to the content of the books taught in schools.
 - b) The curriculum framework provides broad planned guidelines for developing curriculum, textbooks & teaching.
 - c) The National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE 2023) applies only to teacher education.
 - d) Competencies describe the knowledge, skills and attitudes that learners should acquire.
 - e) Learning outcomes are an indicators and pointers of learning progress.
 - f) NCF-FS 2022 is primarily designed for the foundational development of children aged 8-18 years.
 - g) The National Curriculum Frameworks for school education 2023 and foundational stage (2022) are the same.
 - h) The National Curriculum Framework 2023 aims to lighten the learning study material and focus more on core essentials.
2. Write three essential elements of a curriculum.
3. Write two differences between NCF-FS 2022 and NCF-SE 2023
4. Describe the interrelationship between curricular goals, competencies, and learning outcomes with an example.

Answers:

- | | | |
|--------------|----------|-----------|
| 1. a (False) | b (True) | c (False) |
| d (True) | e (True) | f (False) |
| g (False) | h (True) | |

**1.8 LET US SUM UP**

The curriculum sets the direction for teaching and learning. It describes what learners are supposed to learn, thereby ensuring continuity and purpose in teaching. A well-organized curriculum encourages holistic development. Curriculum refers to the totality of student experiences in the schooling process, which mainly includes goals, content, pedagogy and assessment. Whereas curriculum framework provides a detailed and clearly structured blueprint that guides the design and implementation of curriculum in alignment with the national educational goals. In this chapter, we have thoroughly understood the essential elements of curriculum (learning outline, competence, content assessment, etc.), factors affecting curriculum and the basic concepts of curriculum framework and how we will implement it in educational practice. We also got to know the National Curriculum Framework for Foundational Stage (NCF-FS 2022) and National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE 2023) in line with the vision of National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and understood how the curriculum, curricular goals, competencies and learning outcomes are interconnected. The chapter concludes by highlighting the interrelationship between curricular goals, competencies and learning outcomes and how they support a learner-centred and outcome-oriented curriculum that ensures that learners acquire academic practical knowledge along with the skills and values required for real-life application and lifelong learning.

**1.9 END EXERCISES**

Choose any one chapter from a textbook of your choice (Foundational Stage or any stage of schooling). Write the name of the class, subject and chapter. Analyse this chapter in terms of identifying and writing curriculum goals, competencies and learning outcomes. Evaluate how well the chapter adheres to the curricular goals, competencies and learning outcomes mentioned in NCF-FS 2022 and NCF-SE 2023. Also, discuss whether the chapter supports holistic development—including language, cognitive, social-emotional and aesthetic development – by providing specific examples from the content. Suggest any two measures that can enhance its alignment with the curriculum and increase student engagement.

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1.10 REFERENCES

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